

AP[®] English Literature and Composition Practice Exam

From the 2015 Administration

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ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

SECTION I

Time—1 hour

Directions: This section consists of selections from literary works and questions on their content, form, and style. After reading each passage or poem, choose the best answer to each question and then fill in the corresponding circle on the answer sheet.

Note: Pay particular attention to the requirements of questions that contain the words NOT, LEAST, or EXCEPT.

Questions 1-13. Read the following poem carefully before you choose your answers.

To the Same Flower¹

Line
5
10
15
20
25
30

With little here to do or see
Of things that in the great world be,
Daisy! again I talk to thee,
For thou art worthy,
Thou unassuming Common-place
Of Nature, with that homely face,
And yet with something of a grace
Which love makes for thee!

Oft on the dappled turf at ease
I sit, and play with similes,
Loose types of things through all degrees,
Thoughts of thy raising:
And many a fond and idle name
I give to thee, for praise or blame,
As is the humour of the game,
While I am gazing.

A nun demure of lowly port;
Or sprightly maiden, of Love's court,
In thy simplicity the sport
Of all temptations;
A queen in crown of rubies drest;
A starveling in a scanty vest;
Are all, as seems to suit thee best,
Thy appellations.

A little Cyclops with one eye
Staring to threaten and defy.
That thought comes next—and instantly
The freak² is over,
The shape will vanish—and behold
A silver shield with boss of gold,
That spreads itself, some faery bold
In fight to cover!

I see thee glittering from afar—
And then thou art a pretty star;
35 Not quite so fair as many are
In heaven above thee!
Yet like a star, with glittering crest,
Self-poised in air thou seem'st to rest;—
May peace come never to his nest,
40 Who shall reprove thee!

Bright *Flower!* for by that name at last,
When all my reveries are past,
I call thee, and to that cleave fast,
Sweet silent creature!
45 That breath'st with me in sun and air,
Do thou, as thou art wont, repair
My heart with gladness, and a share
Of thy meek nature!

(1807)

¹ An earlier poem by this writer was titled "To the Daisy."

² whim

1. In the first stanza, the speaker views the daisy as
 - (A) a worthy adversary for his arguments
 - (B) an example of God's glory
 - (C) an ordinary yet beloved natural object
 - (D) a beautiful yet uncomprehending part of nature
 - (E) a common yet controversial object of devotion
2. In the first two stanzas, the speaker implies that the poem's setting is
 - (A) fictitious and idealized
 - (B) urban and bustling
 - (C) idyllic and luxurious
 - (D) agricultural and crowded
 - (E) rural and tranquil

3. In the second stanza, the speaker presents the daisy as
 - (A) a positive influence on humankind
 - (B) a source of his own inventiveness
 - (C) a symbol of inconstancy
 - (D) an indecipherable enigma
 - (E) an emblem of divine benevolence
4. Collectively, the images in the third stanza (lines 17-24) are distinguished by their
 - (A) commonness
 - (B) passivity
 - (C) diversity
 - (D) musicality
 - (E) severity
5. In the third stanza, the first three lines contain how many stressed syllables compared to the fourth line?
 - (A) Two versus three
 - (B) Three versus two
 - (C) Four versus three
 - (D) Four versus two
 - (E) Five versus three
6. In lines 27-29 (“—and instantly . . . vanish—”), the speaker depicts the
 - (A) ephemeral quality of the daisy
 - (B) vividness of human experience
 - (C) far-fetched nature of his similes
 - (D) inadequacy of his skill as a poet
 - (E) mercurial nature of his imagination
7. How does the image of the daisy in the fifth stanza (lines 33-40) differ from the previous images?
 - (A) It is more beguiling.
 - (B) It is more playful.
 - (C) It is more changeable.
 - (D) It is grimmer.
 - (E) It is loftier.
8. In lines 39-40, the speaker asks that
 - (A) anyone who criticizes the daisy find no peace
 - (B) any bird who disturbs the daisy find no rest
 - (C) no other flower challenge the beauty of the daisy
 - (D) only he may reprove the daisy
 - (E) peace come to the daisy at last
9. Which best characterizes the shift that occurs in lines 41-43 ?
 - (A) The speaker wearies of the natural world.
 - (B) The speaker returns to the reality of the moment.
 - (C) The speaker’s persona becomes more forceful.
 - (D) The daisy loses its appeal for the speaker.
 - (E) The daisy transforms into a fantastical object.
10. In line 43, “fast” is best understood to mean
 - (A) quickly
 - (B) firmly
 - (C) prematurely
 - (D) recklessly
 - (E) chaotically
11. At the end of the poem, the speaker reveals that he values the daisy most as a
 - (A) pretext for daydreaming
 - (B) stimulus for creativity
 - (C) refreshment to the spirit
 - (D) model for morality
 - (E) symbol of beauty
12. Which line contains an example of apostrophe?
 - (A) Line 25
 - (B) Line 28
 - (C) Line 33
 - (D) Line 39
 - (E) Line 41
13. The poem is characterized by all of the following EXCEPT
 - (A) first-person utterance
 - (B) reference to a specific context
 - (C) direct address to a specific audience
 - (D) the justification of a life decision
 - (E) the representation of a state of mind

Questions 14-24. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

Line Clytie cooked the three meals on the stove, for they
all ate different things, and set the three trays. She
had to carry them in proper order up the stairs. She
frowned in concentration, for it was hard to keep all
5 the dishes straight, to make them come out right in the
end, as Old Lethy could have done. They had had to
give up the cook long ago when their father suffered
the first stroke. Their father had been fond of Old
Lethy, she had been his nurse in childhood, and she
10 had come back out of the country to see him when she
heard he was dying. Old Lethy had come and knocked
at the back door. And as usual, at the first disturbance,
front or back, Octavia had peered down from behind
the curtain and cried, "Go away! Go away! What the
15 devil have you come here for?" And although Old
Lethy and their father had both pleaded that they
might be allowed to see each other, Octavia had
shouted as she always did, and sent the intruder away.
Clytie had stood as usual, speechless in the kitchen,
20 until finally she had repeated after her sister, "Lethy,
go away." But their father had not died. He was,
instead, paralyzed, blind, and able only to call out in
unintelligible sounds and to swallow liquids. Lethy
still would come to the back door now and then, but
25 they never let her in, and the old man no longer heard
or knew enough to beg to see her. There was only one
caller admitted to his room. Once a week the barber
came by appointment to shave him. On this occasion
not a word was spoken by anyone.
30 Clytie went up to her father's room first and set the
tray down on a little marble table they kept by his bed.
"I want to feed Papa," said Octavia, taking the bowl
from her hands.
"You fed him last time," said Clytie.
35 Relinquishing the bowl, she looked down at the
pointed face on the pillow. Tomorrow was the
barber's day, and the sharp black points, at their
longest, stuck out like needles all over the wasted
cheeks. The old man's eyes were half closed. It was
40 impossible to know what he felt. He looked as though
he were really far away, neglected, free. . . . Octavia
began to feed him.
Without taking her eyes from her father's face,
Clytie suddenly began to speak in rapid, bitter words
45 to her sister, the wildest words that came to her head.
But soon she began to cry and gasp, like a small child
who has been pushed by the big boys into the water.
"That is enough," said Octavia.

But Clytie could not take her eyes from her father's
50 unshaven face and his still-open mouth.
"And I'll feed him tomorrow if I want to," said
Octavia. She stood up. The thick hair, growing back
after an illness and dyed almost purple, fell over her
forehead. Beginning at her throat, the long accordion
55 pleats which fell the length of her gown opened and
closed over her breasts as she breathed. "Have you
forgotten Gerald?" she said. "And I am hungry too."
Clytie went back to the kitchen and brought her
sister's supper.
60 Then she brought her brother's.

Excerpt from "Clytie" in A CURTAIN OF GREEN AND OTHER
STORIES, copyright 1941 and renewed 1969 by Eudora Welty,
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Company. All rights reserved.

14. The portion of the narrative involving Lethy (lines 11-21) serves primarily to
- (A) characterize Lethy's motivations
 - (B) show what Octavia is like
 - (C) suggest a mutual dislike between Lethy and the father
 - (D) underscore the importance of Lethy to the family
 - (E) present a memory of Clytie's as a flashback
15. What does the cooking of three separate meals primarily reveal about Clytie?
- (A) How unlike Lethy she is
 - (B) The high priority she gives to her own needs
 - (C) Her position as the head of the family
 - (D) Her comical reaction to her ailing family
 - (E) Her acquiescence to a seemingly unreasonable requirement
16. In lines 43-50, the description of Clytie's lingering attention to her father's face suggests her
- (A) growing realization of his impending death
 - (B) remorse about her past lack of concern for him
 - (C) disgust at his gaunt and deathly appearance
 - (D) need for some sign of affection from him
 - (E) repressed antagonism for the years he neglected her

17. Clytie's behavior in lines 43-47 suggests that she
- (A) is revealing an undefined hatred of her father
 - (B) is overcome by a sense of powerlessness
 - (C) has remembered an extremely painful experience
 - (D) fears for her safety
 - (E) realizes her attachment to Lethy
18. By describing Clytie's "words" (line 44) rather than quoting them, the author primarily
- (A) reveals the sense of peace that follows Clytie's release
 - (B) conceals Clytie's rebellious plans
 - (C) suggests a conspiracy between Clytie and Octavia
 - (D) emphasizes Clytie's anguished emotions
 - (E) shows Clytie's growing sense of self-awareness
19. In lines 52-56 ("The thick . . . breathed"), the physical description of Octavia primarily conveys
- (A) her coarse vitality
 - (B) her hidden vulnerability
 - (C) her mature beauty
 - (D) apparent wealth
 - (E) a family resemblance
20. Octavia's dialogue with Clytie is characterized by
- (A) a repetitiousness that conveys forgetfulness
 - (B) a discursiveness that conveys distractedness
 - (C) a brevity that conveys insecurity
 - (D) an ardor that conveys imagination
 - (E) a terseness that conveys dominance
21. The last line of the passage accomplishes which of the following?
- I. It provides structural closure.
 - II. It reveals the sisters' feelings toward Gerald.
 - III. It suggests an unvaried pattern.
- (A) I only
 - (B) II only
 - (C) I and III only
 - (D) II and III only
 - (E) I, II, and III
22. In the passage, Clytie's character is best described as
- (A) affectionate
 - (B) cruel
 - (C) independent
 - (D) dutiful
 - (E) jealous
23. The passage features all of the following contrasts EXCEPT
- (A) speech and restraint
 - (B) joy and despondence
 - (C) kindness and cruelty
 - (D) duty and devotion
 - (E) control and compliance
24. The passage primarily focuses on the
- (A) dying father's last relationships with family and servants
 - (B) tyranny of Octavia over her father and brother
 - (C) mental and physical worlds of Clytie as her father is dying
 - (D) vengeance visited on the family by those they have wronged
 - (E) relationship of the family to the outside world during the father's illness

Questions 25-32. Read the following poem carefully before you choose your answers.

The Fair Singer

To make a final conquest of all me,
Love did compose so sweet an enemy,
In whom both beauties to my death agree,
Line Joining themselves in fatal harmony;
5 That while she with her eyes my heart does bind,
She with her voice might captivate my mind.

I could have fled from one but singly fair:
My disentangled soul itself might save,
Breaking the curlèd trammels of her hair.
10 But how should I avoid to be her slave,
Whose subtle art invisibly can wreathe
My fetters of the very air I breathe?

It had been easy fighting in some plain,
Where victory might hang in equal choice,
15 Who has th' advantage both of eyes and voice,
But all resistance against her is vain,
And all my forces needs must be undone,
She having gainèd both the wind and sun.

(1681)

25. The speaker presents himself as
- (A) unworthy of the woman's affection
 - (B) jilted by an unfaithful lover
 - (C) unable to overcome his personal weaknesses
 - (D) determined to emerge a conqueror
 - (E) overwhelmed by a powerful adversary
26. The phrase "both beauties" (line 3) refers to
- (A) life and death
 - (B) pleasure and pain
 - (C) a lover and a foe
 - (D) the woman's eyes and voice
 - (E) the speaker's heart and mind
27. In the poem, death is equated with
- (A) ending a romance
 - (B) losing one's faith
 - (C) falling in love
 - (D) winning a battle
 - (E) ceasing to suffer
28. In the context of the poem, the word "trammels" (line 9) suggests
- (A) deception and defeat
 - (B) hindrance and restraint
 - (C) artistic accomplishment
 - (D) military conquest
 - (E) poetic inspiration
29. In line 18, "wind and sun" are mentioned as
- (A) obstacles to love
 - (B) symbols of peace
 - (C) impediments that hinder clear understanding
 - (D) images that contrast with artistic creations
 - (E) elements that benefit one side in a battle

30. In the poem, the fair singer is characterized mainly as

- (A) remote and introspective
- (B) affectionate and doting
- (C) powerful and alluring
- (D) jealous and possessive
- (E) spiteful and cruel

31. The poem personifies which of the following?

- (A) Love
- (B) Death
- (C) War
- (D) The woman's hair
- (E) The wind and sun

32. The speaker says that he might have avoided his present state if

- (A) he had accepted his flaws and tried to improve
- (B) he had employed a more persuasive strategy
- (C) he had addressed his situation with greater conviction
- (D) the woman had possessed only one powerful attribute
- (E) the woman had made less use of nature than of art

Questions 33-45. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

Line Mrs. Jennings was a widow, with an ample
jointure.¹ She had only two daughters, both of whom
she had lived to see respectably married, and she had
5 now therefore nothing to do but to marry all the rest
of the world. In the promotion of this object she was
zealously active, as far as her ability reached; and
missed no opportunity of projecting weddings among
all the young people of her acquaintance. She was
10 remarkably quick in the discovery of attachments, and
had enjoyed the advantage of raising the blushes and
the vanity of many a young lady by insinuations of
her power over such a young man; and this kind of
discernment enabled her soon after her arrival at
15 Barton decisively to pronounce that Colonel Brandon
was very much in love with Marianne Dashwood. She
rather suspected it to be so, on the very first evening
of their being together, from his listening so
attentively while she sang to them; and when the visit
was returned by the Middletons' dining at the cottage,
20 the fact was ascertained by his listening to her again.
It must be so. She was perfectly convinced of it. It
would be an excellent match, for he was rich and she
was handsome. Mrs. Jennings had been anxious to see
Colonel Brandon well married, ever since her
25 connection with Sir John first brought him to her
knowledge; and she was always anxious to get a good
husband for every pretty girl.

The immediate advantage to herself was by no
means inconsiderable, for it supplied her with endless
30 jokes against them both. At the park she laughed at
the colonel, and in the cottage at Marianne. To the
former her raillery was probably, as far as it regarded
only himself, perfectly indifferent; but to the latter it
was at first incomprehensible; and when its object
35 was understood, she hardly knew whether most to
laugh at its absurdity, or censure its impertinence, for
she considered it as an unfeeling reflection on the
colonel's advanced years, and on his forlorn condition
as an old bachelor.

40 Mrs. Dashwood, who could not think a man five
years younger than herself, so exceedingly ancient as
he appeared to the youthful fancy of her daughter,
ventured to clear Mrs. Jennings from the probability
of wishing to throw ridicule on his age.

45 "But at least, mama, you cannot deny the absurdity
of the accusation, though you may not think it
intentionally ill-natured. Colonel Brandon is certainly
younger than Mrs. Jennings, but he is old enough to
be *my* father; and if he were ever animated enough to
50 be in love, must have long outlived every sensation of
the kind. It is too ridiculous! When is a man to be safe
from such wit, if age and infirmity will not protect
him?"

"Infirmity!" said Elinor,² "do you call Colonel
55 Brandon infirm? I can easily suppose that his age may
appear much greater to you than to my mother; but
you can hardly deceive yourself as to his having the
use of his limbs!"

"Did not you hear him complain of the
60 rheumatism? and is not that the commonest infirmity
of declining life?"

"My dearest child," said her mother laughing, "at
this rate you must be in continual terror of *my* decay;
and it must seem to you a miracle that my life has
65 been extended to the advanced age of forty."

"Mama, you are not doing me justice. I know very
well that Colonel Brandon is not old enough to make
his friends yet apprehensive of losing him in the
course of nature. He may live twenty years longer.
70 But thirty-five has nothing to do with matrimony."

(1811)

¹ a financial settlement providing for a wife after her husband's death

² Marianne's sister

33. The tone of the passage is best described as

- (A) scathingly ironic
- (B) subtly moralizing
- (C) playfully satiric
- (D) strongly sentimental
- (E) darkly comic

34. The narrator presents Mrs. Jennings as all of the following EXCEPT

- (A) confident
- (B) selfless
- (C) enthusiastic
- (D) meddlesome
- (E) manipulative

35. The statements "It must be so" (line 21) and
"It would be an excellent match" (lines 21-22)
express the beliefs of

- (A) the narrator
- (B) Mrs. Jennings
- (C) Colonel Brandon
- (D) Mrs. Dashwood
- (E) Marianne Dashwood

36. Lines 21-23 ("It would . . . handsome") evaluate
marriage in terms of

- (A) romantic passion
- (B) personal fulfillment
- (C) domestic habits
- (D) superficial considerations
- (E) ethical obligations

37. Lines 23-27 (“Mrs. Jennings . . . girl”) suggest that Mrs. Jennings is motivated by both
- (A) personal interest and general principle
 - (B) material gain and social convention
 - (C) emotional need and intellectual vanity
 - (D) romantic idealism and mundane pragmatism
 - (E) private ambition and moral duty
38. In context, “indifferent” (line 33) is best interpreted to mean
- (A) inconsistent
 - (B) unbiased
 - (C) apathetic
 - (D) insignificant
 - (E) moderate
39. It can be inferred from lines 35-39 (“she hardly . . . bachelor”) that Marianne primarily considers Mrs. Jennings’ “raillery” (line 32) to be
- (A) impulsive
 - (B) misleading
 - (C) insensitive
 - (D) hypocritical
 - (E) old-fashioned
40. The references to Colonel Brandon’s “advanced years” and “forlorn condition as an old bachelor” (lines 38-39) are best described as
- (A) overstatements
 - (B) concessions
 - (C) euphemisms
 - (D) oxymorons
 - (E) archaisms
41. Marianne emphasizes the “absurdity” (line 45) of Mrs. Jennings’ beliefs because she
- (A) thinks that Colonel Brandon is near death
 - (B) regards Mrs. Jennings as an untrustworthy busybody
 - (C) does not want to admit that she is in love with Colonel Brandon
 - (D) cannot believe that Colonel Brandon could still feel romantic love
 - (E) hopes to provoke Mrs. Jennings into soliciting Colonel Brandon’s feelings directly
42. Elinor’s response to Marianne (lines 54-58) is best described as
- (A) respectful
 - (B) indulgent
 - (C) bemused
 - (D) condescending
 - (E) incredulous
43. Why is Mrs. Dashwood amused by Marianne’s remarks about Colonel Brandon?
- (A) As she is no friend of Colonel Brandon’s, Mrs. Dashwood enjoys hearing him criticized.
 - (B) As she is older than Colonel Brandon, Mrs. Dashwood is entertained by the notion that he is elderly.
 - (C) As she does not agree that Colonel Brandon has intentions, Mrs. Dashwood finds the situation ludicrous.
 - (D) As she has no desire for Marianne to marry, Mrs. Dashwood cannot be serious about the prospect of Colonel Brandon as a suitor.
 - (E) As she is familiar with Marianne’s concerns, Mrs. Dashwood tries to put Colonel Brandon’s intentions in the best light.
44. Mrs. Dashwood’s reference to her own “advanced age” (line 65) is best described as
- (A) facetious
 - (B) deceptive
 - (C) self-effacing
 - (D) solemn
 - (E) concerned
45. Lines 66-70 are best understood as an attempt by Marianne to
- (A) clarify her views about Colonel Brandon
 - (B) reconsider her objections to Colonel Brandon
 - (C) demonstrate her maturity to Mrs. Dashwood
 - (D) express her frustration with Mrs. Dashwood
 - (E) display her intelligence to Elinor

Questions 46-55. Read the following poem carefully before you choose your answers.

A January Dandelion

All Nashville is a-chill! And everywhere,
As wind-swept sands upon the deserts blow,
There is, each moment, sifted through the air
Line 5 A powered blast of January snow.
5 O thoughtless dandelion! to be misled
By a few warm days to leave thy natural bed
Was folly growth and blooming over soon.
And yet, thou blasted, yellow-coated gem!
Full many hearts have but a common boon
10 With thee, now freezing on thy slender stem.
When once the heart-blooms by love's fervid breath
Is left, and chilling snow is sifted in,
It still may beat, but there is blast and death
To all that blooming life that might have been.

(1916)

46. The form of the poem is most accurately described as
- (A) a sestina
 - (B) a sonnet
 - (C) a pastoral elegy
 - (D) a dramatic monologue
 - (E) an English ode
47. Lines 1-4 ("All . . . snow") function primarily to
- (A) identify the location of the poem
 - (B) offer a lament for a bygone era
 - (C) establish the setting and the mood of the poem
 - (D) provide a characterization of the poem's speaker
 - (E) convey the central contradiction of the poem
48. The simile in line 2 ("As . . . blow") achieves which of the following effects?
- I. It provides a striking visual image.
 - II. It conveys a sense of barrenness.
 - III. It creates an atmosphere of danger.
- (A) I only
 - (B) II only
 - (C) III only
 - (D) I and II only
 - (E) I, II, and III
49. The image of "sands" (line 2) most clearly serves to evoke the
- (A) snow blown aloft by the wind
 - (B) dandelion's seeds floating in the air
 - (C) bed in which the dandelion grows
 - (D) time that slips away moment by moment
 - (E) multitude of dandelions blooming
50. In line 5, "thoughtless" is best understood to mean
- (A) remiss
 - (B) indifferent
 - (C) shallow
 - (D) inconsiderate
 - (E) unaware
51. In lines 8-10 ("And yet . . . stem"), the speaker primarily does which of the following?
- (A) Offers a lament for the dandelion's lonely status.
 - (B) Curses the dandelion for its untimely and gaudy display of color.
 - (C) Exhorts the dandelion to take responsibility for its own circumstances.
 - (D) Introduces a comparison between the dandelion's fate and human experience.
 - (E) Suggests that humankind should look to the dandelion for inspiration and comfort.
52. The last four lines of the poem ("When . . . been") primarily imply that
- (A) the bereft heart lives but will never recover from its loss
 - (B) unlike the dandelion, the human heart will ultimately prevail
 - (C) even when love is gone, the beauty it leaves behind remains
 - (D) love is the only protection against the world's hardships
 - (E) sorrow and lost potential are the inevitable consequences of love
53. Which best describes the role of the dandelion in the poem?
- (A) It serves as a symbol for humankind's place in nature.
 - (B) It presents a contrast to the harshness of human experience.
 - (C) It represents the poet's long-standing love of nature.
 - (D) It signals the promise of new beginnings.
 - (E) It provides an occasion for reflection on lost love.

54. Which best describes the speaker's attitude toward the dandelion?

- (A) Affection for its naïve optimism
- (B) Empathy for its predicament
- (C) Envy of its ability to persevere
- (D) Exasperation at its audacity
- (E) Distress at its apparent callousness

55. The overall tone of the poem is best described as

- (A) nostalgic
- (B) determined
- (C) melancholy
- (D) apologetic
- (E) sardonic

S T O P

END OF SECTION I

**IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, YOU MAY
CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS SECTION.**

DO NOT GO ON TO SECTION II UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

MAKE SURE YOU HAVE DONE THE FOLLOWING.

- **PLACED YOUR AP NUMBER LABEL ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **WRITTEN AND GRIDDED YOUR AP NUMBER CORRECTLY ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **TAKEN THE AP EXAM LABEL FROM THE FRONT OF THIS BOOKLET AND PLACED IT ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**

ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

SECTION II

Total time—2 hours

Question 1

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

Read carefully the following poem by Julia Alvarez. Then write a well-organized essay in which you analyze how Alvarez conveys the speaker's discoveries. You may wish to consider such poetic devices as tone, imagery, and selection of detail.

On Not Shoplifting Louise Bogan's* *The Blue Estuaries*

Connecticut College, fall 1968

Line Your book surprised me on the bookstore shelf—
swans gliding on a blueblack lake;
no blurbs by the big boys on back;
5 no sassy, big-haired picture
to complicate the achievement;
no mentors musing
over how they had discovered
you had it in you
before you even knew
10 you had it in you.
The swans posed on a placid lake,
your name blurred underwater
sinking to the bottom.

15 I had begun to haunt
the poetry shelf at the college store—
thin books crowded in by texts,
reference tomes and a spread
of magazines for persistent teens
on how to get their boys,
20 Chaucer-Milton-Shakespeare-Yeats.
Your name was not familiar,
I took down the book and read.

Page after page, your poems
were stirring my own poems—
25 words rose, breaking the surface,
shattering an old silence.
I leaned closer to the print
until I could almost feel
the blue waters drawn
30 into the tip of my pen.

I bore down on the page,
the lake flowed out again,
the swans, the darkening sky.
For a moment I lost my doubts,
35 my girl's voice, my coming late
into this foreign alphabet.
I read and wrote as I read.

I wanted to own this moment.
My breath came quickly, thinking it over—
40 I had no money, no one was looking.
The swans posed on the cover,
their question-mark necks arced
over the dark waters.
I was asking them what to do . . .

45 The words they swam over answered.
I held the book closed before me
as if it were something else,
a mirror reflecting back
someone I was becoming.
50 The swans dipped their alphabet necks
in the blueblack ink of the lake.
I touched their blank, downy sides, musing,
and I put the book back.

* poet (1897–1970)

From *The Other Side/El Otro Lado*. Copyright © 1995 by Julia Alvarez.
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Question 2

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

In the following excerpt from the novel *Moon Tiger* (1987) by Penelope Lively, a brother and sister are searching for fossils while their mother waits nearby. Read the passage carefully. Then write a well-organized essay in which you analyze how Lively uses literary devices to dramatize the complex relationship among the three characters.

Line She climbs a little higher, on to another sliding
shelving plateau of the cliff, and squats searching
furiously the blue grey fragments of rock around her,
5 hunting for those enticing curls and ribbed whorls,
pouncing once with a hiss of triumph—an ammonite,
almost whole. The beach, now, is quite far below; its
shrill cries, its barkings, its calls are clear and loud but
from another world, of no account.

10 And all the time out of the corner of her eye she
watches Gordon, who is higher yet, tap-tapping at an
outcrop. He ceases to tap; she can see him examining
something. What has he got? Suspicion and rivalry
burn her up. She scrambles through little bushy
plants, hauls herself over a ledge.

15 ‘This is my bit,’ cries Gordon. ‘You can’t come
here. I’ve bagged it.’

‘I don’t care,’ yells Claudia. ‘Anyway I’m going up
higher—it’s much better further up.’ And she hurls
herself upwards over skinny plants and dry stony soil
20 that cascades away downwards under her feet, up
towards a wonderfully promising enticing grey
expanse she has spotted where surely *Asteroceras* is
lurking by the hundred.

25 Below, on the beach, unnoticed, figures scurry to
and fro; faint bird-like cries of alarm waft up.

She must pass Gordon to reach that alluring upper
shelf. ‘*Mind . . .*’ she says. ‘Move your *leg . . .*’

‘Don’t *shove*,’ he grumbles. ‘Anyway you can’t
come here. I said this is my bit, you find your own.’

30 ‘Don’t shove yourself. I don’t want your stupid
bit . . .’

His leg is in her way—it thrashes, she thrusts, and
a piece of cliff, of the solid world which evidently is
not so solid after all, shifts under her clutching hands
35 . . . crumbles . . . and she is falling thwack backwards
on her shoulders, her head, her outflung arm, she is
skidding rolling thumping downwards. And comes to
rest gasping in a thorn bush, hammered by pain, too
affronted even to yell.

40 He can feel her getting closer, encroaching, she is
coming here on to his bit, she will take all the best
fossils. He protests. He sticks a foot to impede. Her
hot infuriating limbs are mixed up with his.

‘You’re *pushing* me,’ she shrieks.

45 ‘I’m not,’ he snarls. ‘It’s you that’s shoving.
Anyway this is my place so go somewhere else.’
‘It’s not your stupid place,’ she says. ‘It’s anyone’s
place. Anyway I don’t . . .’

50 And suddenly there are awful tearing noises and
thumps and she is gone, sliding and hurtling down,
and in horror and satisfaction he stares.

‘He pushed me.’

‘I didn’t. Honestly mother, I didn’t. She slipped.’

‘He pushed me.’

55 And even amid the commotion—the clucking
mothers and nurses, the improvised sling, the
proffered smelling salts—Edith Hampton can marvel
at the furious tenacity of her children.

‘Don’t argue. Keep still, Claudia.’

60 ‘Those are *my* ammonites. Don’t let him get them,
mother.’

‘I don’t *want* your ammonites.’

‘Gordon, be quiet!’

65 Her head aches; she tries to quell the children and
respond to advice and sympathy; she blames the
perilous world, so unreliable, so malevolent. And the
intransigence of her offspring whose emotions seem
the loudest sound on the beach.

Excerpt from *Moon Tiger*, copyright © 1987 by Penelope Lively. Used
by permission of Grove/Atlantic, Inc. and David Higham Associates.

Question 3

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

Names are often keys to the significance of literary characters. Select a novel or play in which a central figure's name gives access to that character's ambiguity or complexity. Then write a well-organized essay analyzing how the name illuminates that character and informs the meaning of the work as a whole.

You may choose a work from the list below or another work of comparable literary merit. Do not merely summarize the plot.

1984
Alentejo Blue
Beloved
Brave New World
The Brief Wondrous Life of Oscar Wao
Cat on a Hot Tin Roof
Catch-22
The Color Purple
Death of a Salesman
Erewhon
A Gesture Life
Great Expectations
The Handmaid's Tale
The Importance of Being Earnest
Invisible Man
Jasmine
Light in August
Lolita

Man and Superman
Moby-Dick
The Namesake
Native Son
One Hundred Years of Solitude
Orlando
A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man
A Prayer for Owen Meany
The Scarlet Letter
Shalimar the Clown
Song of Solomon
A Streetcar Named Desire
The Tempest
Their Eyes Were Watching God
Volpone
Waiting for Godot
The Women of Brewster Place

STOP

END OF EXAM

THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS APPLY TO THE COVERS OF THE SECTION II BOOKLET.

- **MAKE SURE YOU HAVE COMPLETED THE IDENTIFICATION INFORMATION AS REQUESTED ON THE FRONT AND BACK COVERS OF THE SECTION II BOOKLET.**
- **CHECK TO SEE THAT YOUR AP NUMBER LABEL APPEARS IN THE BOX(ES) ON THE COVER(S).**
- **MAKE SURE YOU HAVE USED THE SAME SET OF AP NUMBER LABELS ON ALL AP EXAMS YOU HAVE TAKEN THIS YEAR.**

**Answer Key for AP English Literature and Composition
Practice Exam, Section I**

Question 1: C	Question 29: E
Question 2: E	Question 30: C
Question 3: B	Question 31: A
Question 4: C	Question 32: D
Question 5: D	Question 33: C
Question 6: E	Question 34: B
Question 7: E	Question 35: B
Question 8: A	Question 36: D
Question 9: B	Question 37: A
Question 10: B	Question 38: D
Question 11: C	Question 39: C
Question 12: E	Question 40: A
Question 13: D	Question 41: D
Question 14: B	Question 42: E
Question 15: E	Question 43: B
Question 16: A	Question 44: A
Question 17: B	Question 45: A
Question 18: D	Question 46: B
Question 19: A	Question 47: C
Question 20: E	Question 48: D
Question 21: C	Question 49: A
Question 22: D	Question 50: E
Question 23: B	Question 51: D
Question 24: C	Question 52: A
Question 25: E	Question 53: E
Question 26: D	Question 54: B
Question 27: C	Question 55: C
Question 28: B	

AP[®] ENGLISH LITERATURE 2015 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 1

(Julia Alvarez, “On Not Shoplifting Louise Bogan’s *The Blue Estuaries*”)

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9-8 These essays offer a persuasive analysis of Alvarez’s use of poetic devices to convey the speaker’s discoveries. The writers of these essays offer a range of interpretations; they provide convincing readings of both the discoveries and Alvarez’s use of poetic devices. They demonstrate consistent and effective control over the elements of composition in language appropriate to the analysis of poetry. Their textual references are apt and specific. Though they may not be error-free, these essays are perceptive in their analysis and demonstrate writing that is clear and sophisticated, and in the case of a nine (9) essay, especially persuasive.

7-6 These essays offer a reasonable analysis of Alvarez’s use of poetic devices to convey the speaker’s discoveries. They are less thorough or less precise in their discussion of the attitude toward the discoveries and Alvarez’s use of poetic devices, and their analysis of the relationship between the two is less thorough or convincing. These essays demonstrate the writer’s ability to express ideas clearly, making references to the text, although they do not exhibit the same level of effective writing as the 9-8 papers. Essays scored a seven (7) present better-developed analysis and more consistent command of the elements of effective composition than do essays scored a six (6).

5 These essays respond to the assigned task with a plausible reading of Alvarez’s use of poetic devices to convey the speaker’s discoveries, but tend to be superficial in their analysis of the discoveries and of the devices. They often rely on paraphrase, which may contain some analysis, implicit or explicit. Their analysis of the relationship of the speaker’s discoveries or of Alvarez’s use of devices may be vague, formulaic, or minimally supported by references to the text. There may be minor misinterpretations of the poem. These writers demonstrate some control of language, but their essays may be marred by surface errors. These essays are not as well conceived, organized, or developed as 7-6 essays.

4-3 These lower-half essays fail to offer an adequate analysis of the poem. The analysis may be partial, unconvincing, or irrelevant, or may ignore the complexity of the speaker’s discoveries or Alvarez’s use of poetic devices. Evidence from the poem may be slight or misconstrued, or the essays may rely on paraphrase only. The writing often demonstrates a lack of control over the conventions of composition: inadequate development of ideas, accumulation of errors, or a focus that is unclear, inconsistent, or repetitive. Essays scored a three (3) may contain significant misreading and/or demonstrate inept writing.

2-1 These essays compound the weaknesses of the papers in the 4-3 range. Although some attempt has been made to respond to the prompt, the writer’s assertions are presented with little clarity, organization, or support from the poem. These essays may contain serious errors in grammar and mechanics. They may offer a complete misreading or be unacceptably brief. Essays scored a one (1) contain little coherent discussion of the poem.

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

— These essays are entirely blank.

AP[®] ENGLISH LITERATURE 2015 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 2

(Penelope Lively, *Moon Tiger*)

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9-8 These essays offer a persuasive analysis of how Lively uses literary devices to dramatize the complex relationship among the three characters. The writers make a strong case for their interpretation of how the relationship is revealed through the use of various literary devices. They engage the text with apt and specific references. Although these essays may not be error-free, their perceptive analysis is apparent in writing that is clear and effectively organized. Essays scored a nine (9) reveal more sophisticated analysis and more effective control of language than do essays scored an eight (8).

7-6 These essays offer a reasonable analysis of how Lively uses literary elements to dramatize the complex relationship among the three characters. The writers provide a sustained, competent reading of the passage, with attention to particular literary elements. Although these essays may not be error-free and are less perceptive or less convincing than 9-8 essays, the writers present their ideas with clarity and control and refer to the text for support. Essays scored a seven (7) present better-developed analysis and more consistent command of the elements of effective composition than do essays scored a six (6).

5 These essays respond to the assigned task with a plausible reading of the passage, but tend to be superficial or thin in their discussion of how Lively uses literary elements to dramatize the complex relationship among the three characters. While containing some analysis of the passage, implicit or explicit, the discussion of how literary elements contribute to the dramatization of the relationship may be slight, and support from the passage may tend toward summary or paraphrase. While these writers demonstrate adequate control of language, their essays may be marred by surface errors. These essays are not as well conceived, organized, or developed as 7-6 essays.

4-3 These lower-half essays fail to offer an adequate analysis of the passage. The analysis may be partial, unconvincing, or irrelevant; the writers may ignore how Lively dramatizes the relationship or the use of literary elements. These essays may be characterized by an unfocused or repetitive presentation of ideas, an absence of textual support, or an accumulation of errors. Essays scored a three (3) may contain significant misreading and/or demonstrate inept writing.

2-1 These essays compound the weaknesses of the papers in the 4-3 range. They may persistently misread the passage or be unacceptably brief. They may contain pervasive errors that interfere with understanding. Although some attempt has been made to respond to the prompt, the writer's ideas are presented with little clarity, organization, or support from the passage. Essays scored a one (1) contain little coherent discussion of the passage.

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

— These essays are entirely blank.

AP[®] ENGLISH LITERATURE

2015 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 3

(Names As Keys to Character)

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9-8 These essays offer a well-focused and persuasive analysis of how a character's name illuminates the character and informs the meaning of the work as a whole. Using apt and specific textual support, these essays analyze how the meaning of the work as a whole is influenced by the significance of the character's name. Although these essays may not be error-free, they make a strong case for their interpretation and discuss the literary work with significant insight and understanding. Essays scores a nine (9) reveal more sophisticated analysis and more effective control of language than do essays scored an eight (8).

7-6 These essays offer a reasonable analysis of how a character's name illuminates the character and informs the meaning of the work as a whole. These essays analyze how the work as a whole is influenced by the significance of the character's name. While these papers have insight and understanding, their analysis is less thorough, less perceptive, and/or less specific in supporting detail than that of the 9-8 essays. Essays scored a seven (7) present better-developed analysis and more consistent command of the elements of effective composition than do essays scored a six (6).

5 These essays respond to the assigned task with a plausible reading, but they tend to be superficial or thinly developed in analysis. They often rely upon plot summary that contains some analysis, implicit or explicit. Although the writers attempt to discuss how a character's name contributes to the meaning of the work as a whole, they may demonstrate a rather simplistic understanding of the significance of the character's name, and support from the text may be too general. While these writers demonstrate adequate control of language, their essays may be marred by surface errors. These essays are not as well conceived, organized, or developed as 7-6 essays.

4-3 These lower-half essays fail to offer an adequate analysis of how a character's name contributes to the meaning of the work as a whole. The analysis may be partial, unsupported, or irrelevant, and the essays may reflect an incomplete or oversimplified understanding of the significance of the name or its meaning in the work. They may not develop an analysis of how the name contributes to the meaning of the work as a whole, or they may rely on plot summary alone. These essays may be characterized by an unfocused or repetitive presentation of ideas, an absence of textual support, or an accumulation of errors; they may lack control over the elements of college-level composition. Essays scored a three (3) may contain significant misreading and/or demonstrate inept writing.

2-1 Although these essays make some attempt to respond to the prompt, they compound the weaknesses of the papers in the 4-3 range. Often, they are unacceptably brief or incoherent in presenting their ideas. They may be poorly written on several counts and contain distracting errors in grammar and mechanics. The writers' remarks may be presented with little clarity, organization, or supporting evidence. Essays scored a one (1) contain little coherent discussion of the text.

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

— These essays are entirely blank.